

You may also notice a darkening of the skin around your nipples and a darkening of freckles, moles, or birthmarks. A few women may also experience brown patches on their face called [chloasma or the “mask of pregnancy”](#) (see [Increased pigmentation](#)). These changes are caused by the extra amounts of the hormone estrogen during pregnancy, which affects the melanin-producing cells of the skin—these cells produce the pigment that darkens the skin. These color changes are normal and will usually fade once the baby is born.

